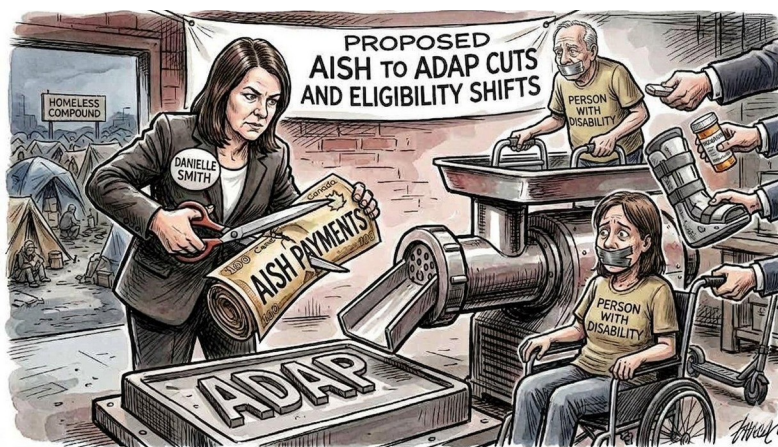


WHAT IS HAPPENING TO YOUR BENEFITS

A Plain Language Guide

For People With Disabilities and the People Who Support Them



This guide is for everyone.

If you have a disability — this explains what is happening in simple words.
If you support someone with a disability — this shows you how to explain it to them.

Every section has a green box at the bottom. That green box gives you exact words to use.

Alberta Disability System Breakdown — April 2026

PAGE 1 — WHAT IS AISH?



AISH HELPS PAY YOUR BILLS.

AISH is money that the government gives you every month.

It helps you pay for a place to live, food, and things you need to stay healthy.
Right now, AISH pays \$1,940 every month.

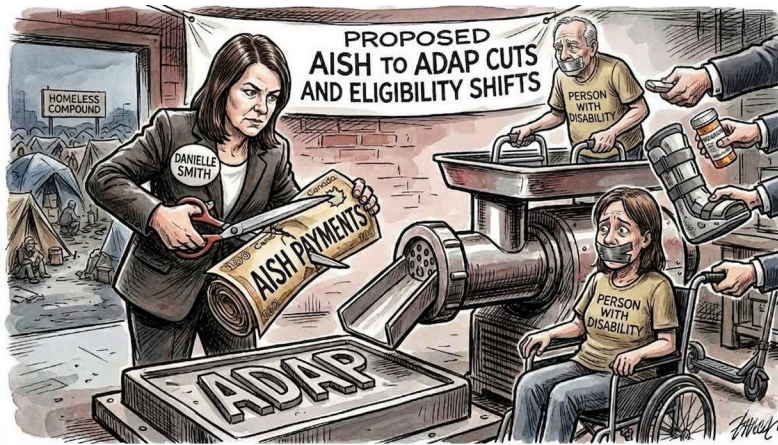
Did You Know?

You did not get AISH by accident. The government tested you and decided you have a serious disability. They made that decision officially. It is on record.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "AISH is money the government sends every month. It helps [name] pay for rent and food and medicine. It is not charity — [name] qualified for it because of their disability."

PAGE 2 — WHAT IS ADAP?



THE GOVERNMENT IS SWITCHING TO A NEW PROGRAM.

ADAP is a new program. It is replacing AISH.

Starting July 1, 2026, everyone on AISH will be moved to ADAP automatically.

You did not ask for this. The government decided to make this change.

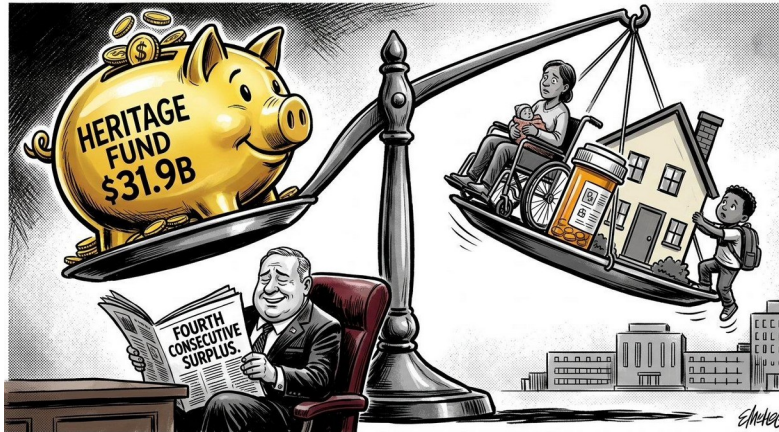
What does 'automatically' mean?

It means it happens whether you want it to or not. You do not need to sign anything. You do not need to do anything for the switch to happen. On July 1, 2026 — it just happens.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The government is switching [name] to a new program called ADAP. It is like they changed the rules. It starts July 1, 2026. We did not choose this — it is happening to everyone on AISH."

PAGE 3 — WHAT IS CHANGING?



YOU WILL GET LESS MONEY.

Under ADAP, you will get \$200 less every month.

AISH pays \$1,940 a month. ADAP pays \$1,740 a month.

The \$200 comes back for a little while — until December 31, 2027. After that, it is gone for good.

Right Now (AISH): \$1,940 / month

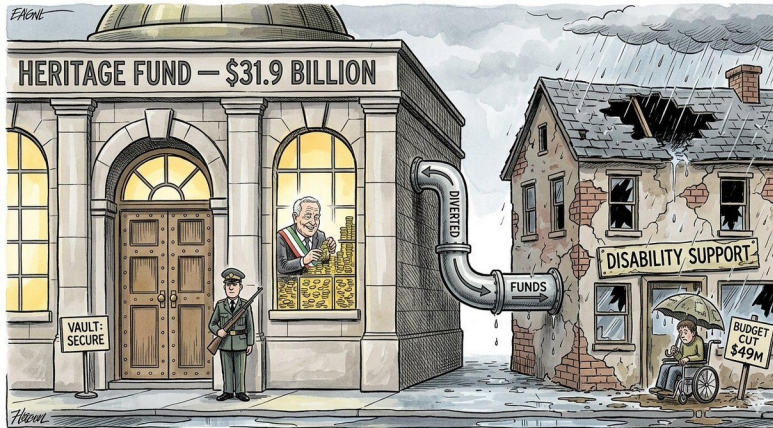
After July 2026: \$1,940 / month (same for now)

After January 2028: \$1,740 / month (\$200 less — forever)

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Right now [name] gets \$1,940 every month. After July 2026, that stays the same for a while. But after December 2027, it drops by \$200. That is \$200 less every month — forever. That is like losing \$2,400 every year."

PAGE 4 — HOW THEY SAY THEY CAN AFFORD IT



**THE GOVERNMENT SAYS THEY ARE OUT OF MONEY.
WATCH THIS.**

The government says they have to cut AISH because they cannot afford it.

But the same government lost \$49 million in one bad medicine deal.
That is the same amount they are cutting from AISH.

\$49 million lost on a medicine mistake.
\$49 million cut from disability support.

The money is not missing. It is going somewhere else.

What is 'fiscal hypocrisy'?

It means saying one thing about money and doing another. The government says they have no money for you. But they have money for other things. They are choosing where the money goes.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The government says they have no choice — they have to cut AISH to save money. But they wasted the same amount on one medicine deal. The money is there. They are choosing not to spend it on us."

PAGE 5 — RENT AND FOOD

[IMAGE NEEDED]

Suggested: A simple cartoon showing a person looking at empty kitchen shelves or an unpaid rent bill. Or a split image: rent receipt on one side, empty fridge on the other. Visual metaphor for 'the math does not work.'

THE MONEY DOES NOT MATCH WHAT IT COSTS TO LIVE.

Rent in Alberta is high. AISH does not cover it.

Average rent for a one-bedroom: \$1,500 to \$1,900 a month.

AISH pays: \$1,940 a month.

After rent, some people have only \$40 left for the whole month.

\$40 is not enough to buy food, power, heat, soap, or bus fare.

This is before ADAP cuts \$200.

It is not a budgeting problem.

Some people say 'just budget better.' But you cannot budget money you do not have. Rent is fixed. Food costs what it costs. Heat costs what it costs. The math does not work — even before ADAP cuts your money.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Rent in our area is about [amount]. AISH is \$1,940. After rent, [name] has almost nothing left. After ADAP cuts another \$200, it gets worse. This is not about being bad with money. The money is not enough to live on."

PAGE 6 — WHAT ABOUT THE KIDS?

[IMAGE NEEDED]

Suggested: A cartoon showing a parent at a desk surrounded by paperwork, with children waiting. Or a split image showing FSCD/PDD waiting room with a clock showing years passing. Visual metaphor for the 3-year wait and family burden.

CHILDREN WITH DISABILITIES WAIT YEARS. PARENTS PAY THE COST.

If your child has a disability, the wait for help is very long.

FSCD (help for children with disabilities): about 3 years to get full services.

PDD (help for adults with disabilities): the waitlist is hidden. The government will not say how long it is.

Most daycares cannot take children with big support needs. Most do not have trained staff.

That means parents stay home. Parents lose income. Families fall behind on bills.

When AISH gets cut, families that were already stretched thin are pushed further.

What happens at age 18?

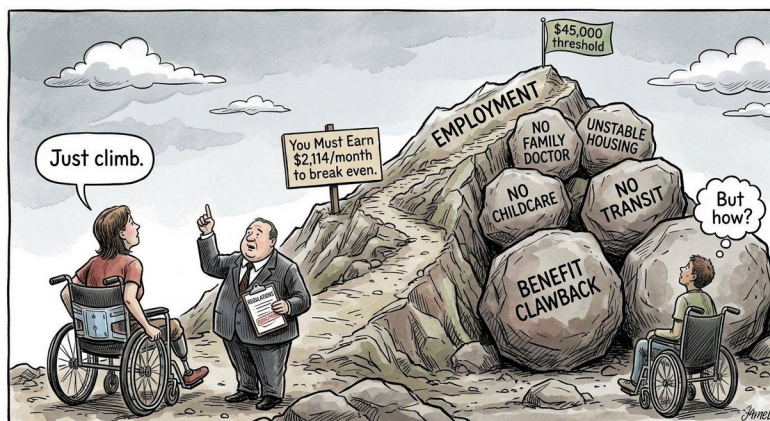
When a child with a disability turns 18, FSCD ends. They are supposed to move to PDD. But the PDD waitlist can be years long. Some young adults wait with no support at all.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "If [name] has a child who needs FSCD, the wait is about three years. Most daycares cannot take kids with big needs. Parents end up staying home. That makes the AISH cuts hit even harder — there are already no other

supports."

PAGE 7 — "WORK MORE" — BUT THE JOBS AREN'T THERE



THE GOVERNMENT SAYS WORK MORE. THE REAL JOB MARKET IS DIFFERENT.

ADAP is supposed to help people work more. But here is what gets in the way:

- Severe disabilities do not follow a work schedule.
- Many employers will not hire people with visible disabilities.
- Many places do not have buses that go where the jobs are.
- Many people fight for years just to get a workplace accommodation.
- To break even on ADAP, you would need to earn \$2,114 a month.

This is not about wanting to work. Many people on AISH already work part-time or want to.

The government is treating a medical problem like a motivation problem.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The government says ADAP will help [name] work more. But [name]'s disability does not follow a work schedule. And most jobs do not accommodate that. Wanting to work is not the problem. The barriers are the problem."

PAGE 8 — THE MONEY IS THERE. THIS IS A CHOICE.

[IMAGE NEEDED]

Suggested: A cartoon showing the Heritage Fund as a giant overflowing pot of money next to a small disability support box being shrunk. Or a split image: Heritage Fund growing on one side, AISH being cut on the other. Visual metaphor for 'the money exists, they chose where it goes.'

ALBERTA HAS BILLIONS SAVED. THEY ARE STILL CUTTING AISH.

Alberta has a savings account called the Heritage Fund.

Right now, the Heritage Fund has \$31.9 billion in it.

The government has had money left over four years in a row.
They have been growing the Heritage Fund.

They are still saying they cannot afford disability supports.

**Cutting AISH is not a money problem.
It is a choice about where the money goes.**

What is a 'surplus'?

A surplus is when the government takes in more money than it spends. Alberta has had a surplus four years in a row. That means there is extra money. The government is choosing to put it in the Heritage Fund instead of helping people on AISH.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Alberta has a \$31.9 billion savings account. They had extra money four years in a row. They still say they cannot afford to keep AISH the way it is. That is not a fact — that is a choice."

PAGE 9 — WHAT DO YOU HAVE TO DO?



THE OFFICIAL REVIEW PROCESS.

YOU DO NOT HAVE TO MOVE TO ADAP WITHOUT A FIGHT.

The switch to ADAP happens automatically — but you can ask to stay on AISH.

To ask to stay on AISH, you need a doctor to fill out a special form. The government will pay for one medical check-up to fill out that form.

Step 1: Gather all your medical papers. Any letter from a doctor. Any test results.

Step 2: Call your AISH worker. Say: 'I want to apply for AISH reassessment after July 1.'

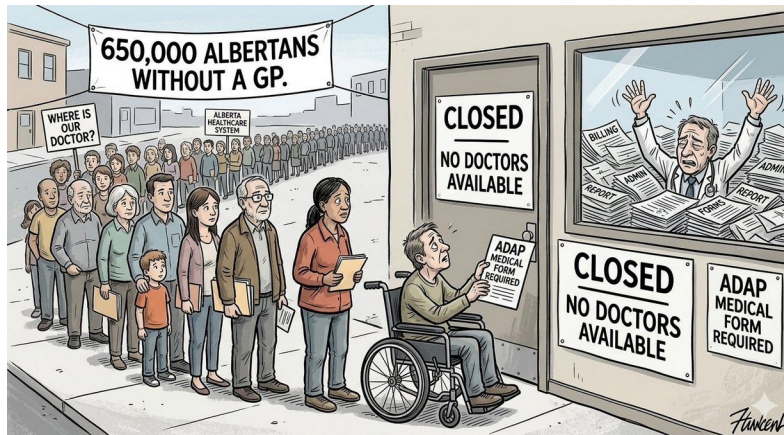
Step 3: Ask your doctor to fill out the Disability Assistance Medical Report form.

Step 4: Write down every phone call. Date, time, and what they said.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The switch happens no matter what. But [name] can ask to go back to AISH after. To do that, a doctor has to fill out a form. The government will pay for it. The most important thing right now is to keep all the papers from the doctor."

PAGE 10 — WHY IS THIS HARD?



THERE ARE NOT ENOUGH DOCTORS.

To stay on AISH, you need a doctor to sign a form.

But right now, 650,000 Albertans have no family doctor.

Walk-in doctors usually will not fill out disability forms for someone they just met. Specialists can help with some parts, but not all of the form.

- No doctor = no form.
- No form = no AISH reassessment.
- **No reassessment = you stay on ADAP — at the lower payment.**

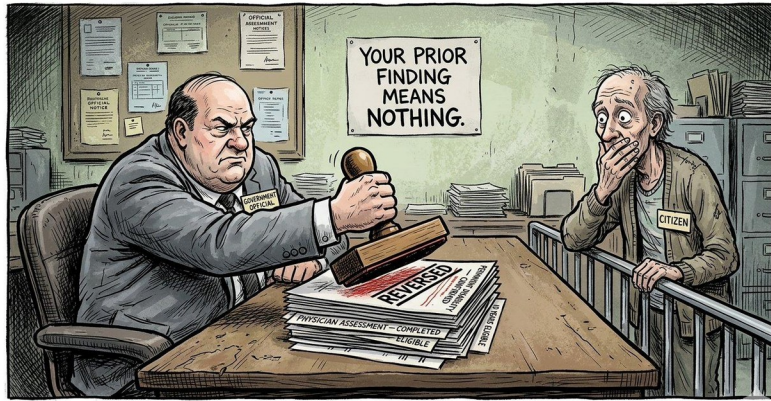
What can you do if you have no doctor?

Call Alberta Supports at 1-877-644-9992. Ask them for the list of doctors who can complete the ADAP medical form. Also ask your AISH office — they are required to help connect you.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The government says [name] needs a doctor to sign a form to stay on AISH. But there are not enough doctors. That is not [name]'s fault — the government let that happen. We are trying to find a doctor who can help. Here is what we need to do together."

PAGE 11 — THEY ALREADY SAID YOU QUALIFY



THE OFFICIAL REVIEW PROCESS.

NOTHING ABOUT YOU CHANGED. THE RULES DID.

When you got AISH, the government checked your health. A trained person looked at your file.

They decided: yes, you have a serious disability. Yes, you qualify.

Your health did not improve. No new tests came back.

But now they are asking you to prove it all over again.

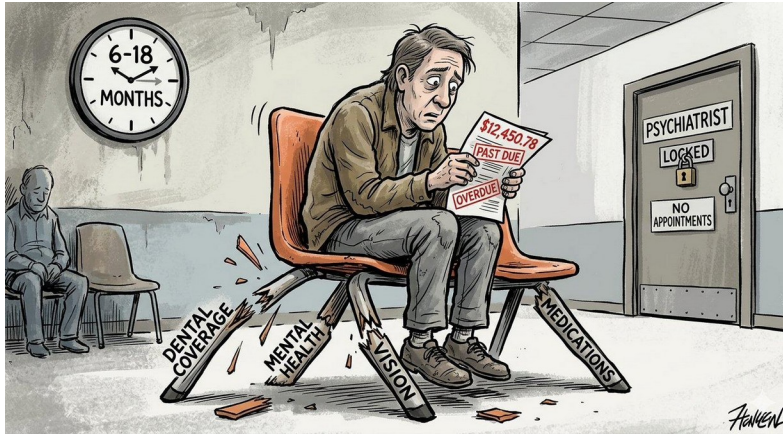
This is called a 'Prior Finding.'

A prior finding means the government already made an official decision about you. In law, if nothing changed, the government needs a reason to reverse their own decision. They did not give one. That is important — and it is on record.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The government already checked [name] and officially said they have a disability. That decision is still true — [name]'s health did not change. They are asking [name] to prove it again even though nothing is different. That is not fair, and we are saying so in writing."

PAGE 12 — WHAT ARE YOU LOSING?



SOME IMPORTANT THINGS ARE GOING AWAY.

It is not just the money. Other things are changing too.

■ **Your personal caseworker is gone.**

You used to have one person who knew your file, your name, and your situation. That person has been replaced by a call centre. Many people wait hours and get no answer.

■ **Dental coverage got worse.**

There are now hard limits on cleaning. Some back teeth cannot get crowns anymore. Adults no longer get fluoride. If your medication causes gum problems, there are no exceptions.

■ **Your appeal rights changed.**

A law called Bill 12 was passed in December 2025. It removed the appeal panel that used to review decisions about your file. Decisions are now final at the Medical Review Panel level.

■ **The Canada Disability Benefit is taken back.**

The federal government created a \$200/month benefit for disabled Canadians. Alberta counts that \$200 as income. So they take \$200 off your AISH. You end up with the same amount of money as before — even though Canada sent you extra.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "It is not just less money. [Name] also lost the person who used to answer their questions. And if [name] disagrees with a decision, it is much harder to fight it now. These are real changes — and it is okay to be upset about them."

PAGE 13 — REAL FAMILIES, REAL COSTS

[IMAGE NEEDED]

Suggested: A warm but realistic cartoon showing a single parent at a kitchen table with two children, calculator and unpaid bills in front of them. Not despairing — just tired. Visual metaphor for 'this is what \$200 looks like in a real life.'

THIS IS WHAT HAPPENS WHEN THE NUMBERS BECOME REAL.

When we talk about \$200 a month, this is what it looks like in one made-up but typical family.

Sarah is a single parent. She has two kids. She has chronic pain and depression. She is on AISH.

Sarah's rent is \$1,650.

Power and heat: \$180.

Phone: \$50.

Bus pass: \$100.

That leaves about \$160 for food, soap, school supplies, and clothes for two growing kids — for the whole month.

Now ADAP cuts \$200 from her AISH.

Sarah cannot pay rent. She cannot buy food. The kids go without.

This is not a story. This is the math.

There are about 79,000 families like Sarah's in Alberta.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "When the government talks about ADAP, they talk about numbers. But \$200 a month is not a number. It is rent. It is food. It is school clothes. For 79,000 people in Alberta, this is real."

[IMAGE NEEDED]

Suggested: A simple cartoon showing a person standing tall with a Charter of Rights document in hand, or a balanced scale of justice with disability symbol. Visual metaphor for 'the law protects you.'

IN CANADA, YOU CANNOT BE TREATED UNFAIRLY BECAUSE OF YOUR DISABILITY.

The Alberta Human Rights Act says the government cannot treat you differently just because you have a disability.

If you think the ADAP decision is unfair, you can make a complaint.

It is free. You do not need a lawyer.

- Physical Disability — If your physical condition qualifies you for AISH, cutting your benefits may be discrimination.
- Mental Disability — Depression, anxiety, PTSD, developmental disabilities — all are protected.
- Family Status — If you are a parent caring for a child with disabilities, that is also protected.

How to file — it takes about 20 minutes

1. Go to albertahumanrights.ab.ca — OR call 1-800-232-7215. 2. Use the Complaint Checker on their website first. 3. Fill out the form. Say what happened, when, and why it is unfair. 4. Wait until AFTER you get your official ADAP decision letter before filing. 5. You have ONE YEAR from the date of the decision to file.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "If we think this is unfair, we can make a free complaint. We fill out a form and send it to the Human Rights Commission. They look into it. We should wait until [name] gets the official letter first, then we can do it together."

PAGE 15 — WHAT CAN YOU DO?



YOU CAN WRITE A LETTER. IT MATTERS.

You can write to the people who made this decision.

You do not need to write much. Two sentences is enough.

Say your name, where you live, and how ADAP will affect your life.

Step 1: Find your MLA. Go to contact.assembly.ab.ca/mla-finder and type your postal code.

Step 2: Write one email. Say your name, your city, one sentence about your situation, and that you want a written response.

Step 3: Send it to everyone at once. See the contact list on the next page.

Step 4: No reply in 3 days? Send it again. Say: 'This is my second contact. I am waiting for a written response.'

A simple email that works

"My name is [Name]. I live in [City]. I am on AISH and I have [your disability]. The switch to ADAP will mean I have \$200 less every month. That will make it very hard to pay my rent. I am asking for your written response about what you are doing to protect people like me."

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "We are going to write a letter together. I will help you. You just need to tell me: your name, your city, and one thing about how this affects

you. I will write the rest. It only takes a few minutes."

PAGE 16 — WHO DO YOU WRITE TO?

SEND YOUR EMAIL TO ALL OF THESE PEOPLE AT THE SAME TIME.

Your MLA (Member of the Legislative Assembly)

This is the person who speaks for your neighbourhood at the government.

Find yours: contact.assembly.ab.ca/mla-finder

Type your postal code. Write down the name and email.

Minister Jason Nixon

He is the minister in charge of AISH and ADAP.

alss.minister@gov.ab.ca

Premier Danielle Smith

She is the head of the Alberta government.

premier@gov.ab.ca

The ADAP Program Directly

This goes into your file.

adapengagement@gov.ab.ca

Your Federal MP

Your federal member of parliament — they represent you in Ottawa.

Find yours: ourcommons.ca/members/en/search

Alberta Ombudsman

If something went wrong with your file, they investigate.

info@ombudsman.ab.ca | 1-888-455-2756

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "We are going to send the same email to six people. That way,

no one person can ignore it and say it was someone else's job. When everyone gets the same email, everyone is responsible."

PAGE 17 — FREE MONEY YOU MIGHT NOT KNOW ABOUT

[IMAGE NEEDED]

Suggested: A simple cartoon showing money growing in a savings jar with 'RDSP' label, or a hand offering money to a person. Visual metaphor for 'help is available — go get it.' Should feel hopeful, not sad.

THE RDSP — THE GOVERNMENT WILL PUT MONEY IN AN ACCOUNT FOR YOU.

If you have the Disability Tax Credit (DTC), the government will give you up to \$1,000 a year in a special savings account.

You do not have to put any of your own money in.

Under AISH, the money does NOT count against your benefits.

ADAP rules are still being finalized — check before you rely on this for ADAP.

If you have never opened one, you may be able to get up to \$11,000 in back payments.

HOW TO GET STARTED — FREE HELP IS AVAILABLE

Call Plan Institute: 1-844-311-7526

Website: rdsp.com

They will walk you through the whole process at no cost.

THE CANADIAN DENTAL CARE PLAN — CHECK IF YOU QUALIFY.

The federal government has a program to help pay for dental care. Most AISH recipients qualify. Having the AISH Blue Cross card does not disqualify you.

- You must have filed your taxes.
- Your family income must be under \$90,000 a year.
- You must be a Canadian resident.

Important Deadlines Right Now

Already enrolled? Renew before June 1, 2026 or your coverage ends June 30. Not enrolled yet? Applications open June 2, 2026. Apply or renew at canada.ca/dental — or call 1-833-537-2635.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There is free money that [name] might not be getting. One is a savings account the government puts money into every year — no cost. The other helps pay for the dentist. Let's check together if [name] qualifies."

PAGE 18 — YOU ARE NOT ALONE



LOTS OF PEOPLE ARE GOING THROUGH THE SAME THING.

There are 79,000 people on AISH in Alberta. Every single one of them is being moved to ADAP.

You do not have to figure this out alone.

There is a group where people share information, ask questions, and help each other.

JOIN THE GROUP

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

[INSERT QR CODE HERE — scan to join]

Free to join. You can ask questions. You can share your story if you want to. You can also just read and listen.

NEED THE FULL DOCUMENTS?

There are full sourced reports with all the details and evidence.

Email: albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com

They are free. Word files. Ready to send. Just ask.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There are thousands of people dealing with this same thing. There is a group online where people help each other. You can join and just read, or ask questions — whatever feels comfortable. And if you ever need help filling out a form or writing a letter, we can do it together."